

Note for **Valdorian Times Cyberinvestigations**

2 days on 14.April 2026

This analyst investigated an email phishing attack in Valdoria that uncovered a politically motivated influence campaign. Using Kusto Query Language (KQL), they analyzed employee roles, email communications, and computer process events, revealing evidence of data exfiltration and manipulation. This exercise reinforced skill in querying data and understanding data integrity within a cybersecurity context.

```
Info "ronnie_mclovin@valdoriantimes.news "  
"ronnie_ip"= 10.10.0.19  
url= https://promotionrecruit.org/share/Editorial_J0b_Openings_2024.docx  
"hostname_value"= A37A-DESKTOP
```

IP address Havkers= 168.57.191.100

Hacker used plink.exe

```
Employees  
| where name contains "ronnie"
```

How many total emails were sent by this email sender to users at The Valdorian Times?

When did valdorias_best_recruiter@gmail.com send an email to Ronnie McLovin?*

What domain was in the link from that email?

What was the subject of that email?

```
Email  
| where sender == "valdorias_best_recruiter@gmail.com" and recipient contains  
"ronnie_mclovin@valdoriantimes.news"
```

When did Ronnie click on the link in the email from

What was the name of the .docx file that was downloaded to Ronnie's machine?

```
OutboundNetworkEvents  
| where src_ip contains "10.10.0.19"  
| where url contains  
"https://promotionrecruit.org/share/Editorial_J0b_Openings_2024.docx"
```

When was this docx file downloaded?

```
FileCreationEvents  
| where hostname contains "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where filename contains "Editorial_J0b_Openings_2024.docx"
```

When was the .ps1 file dropped to Ronnie's machine?

```
ProcessEvents  
| where hostname contains "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_name contains ".ps1"
```

What IP address was used with plink on Ronnie's machine?

What username was used with plink on Ronnie's machine?

What password was used with plink on Ronnie's machine?

ProcessEvents

```
| where hostname contains "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline contains "plink"
```

How many discovery commands were run on Ronnie's machine?

ProcessEvents

```
| where hostname contains "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline !contains "."
```

What is Ronnie's IP address?

Employees

```
| where name contains "ronnie"
```

What is the full URL fakestory.docx was downloaded from?

Employees

```
| where name contains "ronnie"
```

OutboundNetworkEvents

```
| where src_ip contains "10.10.0.19"  
| where url contains "fakestory.docx"
```

What is the sha256 hash of fakestory.docx on Ronnie's machine?

When was fakestory.docx created on Ronnie's machine?

FileCreationEvents

```
| where hostname contains "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where filename contains "fakestory.docx"
```

what the attackers did after they downloaded fakestory.docx by looking at *ProcessEvents* for Ronnie's machine. After downloading fakestory.docx, the attackers ran a *command* to rename and move the file to a different location.

What is the new path for the document?

When was this command executed to rename and move the file?

ProcessEvents

```
| where hostname contains "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline contains "move"
```

2024-01-31T10:26:20Z

When was `OpEdFinal_to_print.docx` emailed from Ronnie's account to Clark Kent?

What was the subject line of this email?

Email

```
| where sender == "ronnie_mclovin@valdorianimes.news" and recipient contains  
"clark_kent@valdorianimes.news"
```

2024-01-31T11:11:12.000Z

How many minutes elapsed between when the file was moved/renamed on Ronnie machine and when the email was sent to Clark Kent?

In google.com

time calculation 2024-01-31T10:26:20Z- 2024-01-31T11:11:12.000Z

Wow! So it looks like the attackers downloaded the fake story, renamed it `OpEdFinal_to_print.docx`, and then sent the file to `Clark Kent` using Ronnie's email!

What is the domain mentioned in this alert?

`hirerecruit.com`

How many total commands were run in this timeframe?

```
ProcessEvents  
| where timestamp between (datetime(2024-01-21 07:00:00) .. datetime(2024-01-21  
12:00:00))  
| where hostname == "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| order by timestamp asc
```

right after renaming `fakestory.docx` to `OpEdFinal_to_print.docx`, the attackers ran commands to steal (exfiltrate) data from Ronnie's machine.

One command the attackers ran leveraged 7zip to compress all of Ronnie's dank memes into a .7z file.

What is the name of the .7z file that contains the stolen memes?

```
ProcessEvents  
| where hostname == "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline contains "memes"
```

What is the name of the .7z file that contains files stolen from Ronnie's Documents folder?

```
ProcessEvents  
| where hostname == "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline contains "Document"
```

What is the name of the .7z file that contains files stolen from Ronnie's Desktop folder?
What is the password the attackers used to encrypt all of the .7z files?

```
ProcessEvents  
| where hostname == "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline contains "DESKTOP"
```

After compressing all the stolen data into .7z files, the attackers *exfiltrated* the data by uploading it to a custom portal on their website.

What is the full command the attackers ran to do this?

<https://github.com/microsoft/Microsoft-365-Defender-Hunting-Queries/blob/master/Exfiltration/detect-archive-exfiltration-to-competitor.md>

What domain was the stolen data uploaded to?

```
ProcessEvents  
| where hostname == "A37A-DESKTOP"  
| where process_commandline contains "7z"
```

Query ProcessEvents for all devices at Valdorian Times.

Was data stolen from any other devices and uploaded to hirejob.com? (yes/no)

```
ProcessEvents  
| where process_commandline contains "hirejob.com"
```